

Email Gating

Must-have for launch:

1. Usage tracking (SMS, Email, AI)
2. Send blocking logic
3. Monthly limits
4. Basic UI usage display

Can be added after:

- Advanced overage billing UI
- Bounce rate automation
- Cost forecasting

Goal:

Protect against:

- Carrier overcharges (SMS)
- Email provider costs
- AI usage losses

While still allowing:

- Free users to experience product (email)
- Paid users to scale usage safely

EMAIL GATING (FREEMIUM MODEL)

Plan Access

- Email is enabled on ALL plans (including free)

Usage Tracking (per user)

- email_monthly_limit
- email_used_this_cycle
- email_overage_used
- email_overage_rate = 0.001 – 0.003

Plan Limits

- Free plan → 300 emails/month capped
- Paid plans → higher limits

Send Logic

Before sending:

- Check email_used_this_cycle
- Check daily send cap
- Check domain verification (SPF/DKIM)

Overage Rules

- Free plan → NO overage (hard stop)
- Paid plans → allow overage + track usage

Safety Controls

- Daily cap for starter plan 350 emails and growth plan 700 emails
- Bounce rate monitoring
- Pause sending if bounce rate too high

3. AI USAGE CONTROL (CRITICAL)

We must track and limit AI usage to prevent cost losses.

Track per user:

- ai_messages_limit
- ai_used_this_cycle
- ai_overage_used (optional)
- ai_cost_per_message

Limits

- Free plan → small limit (ex: 50–100 messages)
- Paid plans → higher limits

Logic

Before generating AI: I

- If ai_used_this_cycle >= ai_messages_limit

Optional:

- Allow overage + track separately

4. GLOBAL USAGE SYSTEM (IMPORTANT)

All usage resets monthly based on billing cycle.

Each user must have:

- billing_cycle_start_date
- billing_cycle_end_date

At reset:

- Reset all usage counters:
 - SMS
 - Email
 - AI
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5. UI REQUIREMENTS

Show usage everywhere:

- “X / Y used” for:
 - SMS
 - Email
 - AI
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Warnings:

- 70% usage → soft warning
- 85% → strong warning
- 100% → block or show overage

Before sending:

- Show estimated usage:
 - “This will send 2,500 emails”
 - If over limit → show estimated cost

6. CORE RULES (MUST ENFORCE)

System MUST prevent:

- Sending SMS without approved 10DLC
- Unlimited email/sms sending
- Unlimited AI usage
- Sending beyond daily caps

System MUST support:

- Usage tracking per user
- Monthly reset
- Overage billing
- Upgrade prompts